WHAT ARE COOKIES?

How a website remembers you after you log in.

A cookie is a tiny piece of data a website stores in your browser. Think of the **token slip** a restaurant gives you: show it next time and they know it's you.

HOW IT WORKS

1. You log in. The server replies with a header: `Set-Cookie: session=abc123`.
2. Your browser saves it.
3. On every next request, the browser sends it back automatically.
4. The server sees `abc123` and knows who you are.

WHY YOU STAY LOGGED IN

- Login sessions
- Items in your cart
- Dark mode and language settings

SECURITY FLAGS

Flag	What it does
HttpOnly	JavaScript cannot read it (protects from theft)
Secure	Sent only over HTTPS
SameSite	Limits sending it on cross-site requests
Expires / Max-Age	When the cookie dies

TRY IT YOURSELF

```
F12 → Application tab → Cookies → pick a site
See the names, values and flags.

Console: document.cookie    // shows cookies JS may read
```

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